

LaTeX vs Typst

Comparison Overview

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What are they?

- ▶ LaTeX: Mature typesetting system based on TeX
- ▶ Typst: Modern markup-based typesetting system

Key Differences

- ▶ LaTeX is decades old; Typst is new
- ▶ LaTeX is complex; Typst is simple
- ▶ LaTeX is slow to compile; Typst is fast
- ▶ LaTeX has massive ecosystem; Typst is growing

LaTeX Pros

- ▶ Extremely mature and stable
- ▶ Huge academic adoption
- ▶ Powerful packages (TikZ, BibTeX)
- ▶ Best for complex scientific documents

LaTeX Cons

- ▶ Steep learning curve
- ▶ Slow compilation
- ▶ Cryptic errors
- ▶ Fragmented syntax

Typst Pros

- ▶ Very fast compilation
- ▶ Clean, modern syntax
- ▶ Easier to learn
- ▶ Consistent built-in system

Typst Cons

- ▶ Smaller ecosystem
- ▶ Less academic adoption
- ▶ Still evolving

Conclusion

- ▶ Use LaTeX for academic rigor and legacy workflows
- ▶ Use Typst for speed, simplicity, and modern workflows